

A COPTIC "LETTER OF ORDERS."

BY W. E. CRUM.

The manuscript here published was bought of a Cairo dealer last winter. It consists of a strip of stout, yellow-brown, oriental paper, $21\frac{1}{2}$ in. long by $7\frac{1}{2}$ in. wide. Above the text is a slender cross, about $3\frac{1}{2}$ in. high, in red, yellow, and black, on either side of which are a rosette and two fantastic birds in the same colours. In the four angles of the cross are the words $\overline{\text{IHC}} \overline{\text{N}} \overline{\text{XC}} \overline{\text{NI}} \overline{\text{KZ}}$ (*νίκα*). Below these is a horizontal line of small interlacing crosses similarly coloured. In the side margin of the text is one and in the lower margin are two birds, drawn and coloured like the rest. The script of the Coptic text, from l. 9 onwards, is that usual in the 14th century (*cf.* Hyvernât, *Album* LIII, 1 and 2), while ll. 2-4, 6-8 show the large, archaistic hand frequently used at the period for the initial lines of a text. Line 1 is in quite small characters; l. 5 in less small. The second at least of these appears to have been inserted after the rest of the text was written. The script of the Arabic version is tolerably regular. The letters generally have the points but are often not fully formed.

The text itself is a mediæval example of a Coptic "Letter of Orders," the testimonial to ordination received by every cleric from the bishop by whom he has been ordained.* It consists, in the present instance, of (1) a protocol, (2) the bishop's declaration of the completed ordination, with its date and the church to which the ordained is appointed, (3) the further declaration that the ordained is competent to officiate, (4) an invocation of God's blessing upon him, (5) the definition of his rank among his fellows.

* The only similar documents that I have found in the Catalogues are Paris, *Arab.* No. 316, from the Patriarch to a deacon, and *ib.*, Nos. 317-319, and Bodl., *Cat.* II, 475, from Patriarchs to churchwardens. Our text is considerably older than any of these.

Such a document is in Egypt called a *Taklid*.* It corresponds in the Latin church to the *Littera Testimonialis*;† but it is difficult to ascertain by which term it is exactly represented among the Greeks. According to one canonist it would appear to be contained in the *συστατικὴ γραφή*, where it is combined with the recommendation of the ordained when abroad to the clergy of another diocese.‡ The Greek rituals mention, in each ordination, the paper (*χαρτα*) handed to the bishop by the registrar or archdeacon, and containing the preliminary declaration of the candidate's fitness, etc.; but no reference is made to the Letter of Orders, the reason presumably being that this is granted only after the orders have been conferred and the service ended, and that it therefore forms no integral part of the ritual.§

The words of ll. 6-19 are, it will be noticed, almost a repetition of those already pronounced in the service by archdeacon and bishop, and found thus in *MSS. Brit. Mus. Or.* 1323, fol. 21^a, and *Curzon* 144:—

ΕΠΦΩΓΕΝ ΠΠΠ ΠΔΙΑΚΟΝΟΣ ΕΠΙΔΑΠΕΡΩΟΥΣΥ
ΕΤΑΥΤΡΑΝ ΕΡΟΥ ΠΤΕ ΠΙΟΡΘΟΔΟΧΟΣ ΠΤΕ ΤΕΚΚΛΗΣΙΑ
ΠΤΕ ΠΠΠ ΑΠΟΛΙΣ ΔΕΠΦΡΑΝ ΑΦΙΩΤ ΠΕΠΠΥΗΡΙ
ΠΕΠΠΠΠΠ ΕΘΟΥΔΒ ΔΕΗΠ. ||

Both Coptic and Arabic are here printed as they stand in the MS., a few points, vowels, etc., only being added in the latter.

* *تقليد*. Vansleb (*Histoire*, 163) uses this term with reference only to the consecration of the Patriarch. To-day, at any rate, it is applied equally to the documents received by the inferior orders and even by lay officers, *e.g.*, the *ناظر* or churchwarden (*v.* Bodl., *Cat.* II, 481 note). *Cf.* also Renaudot, *Hist.*, 488.

† Ferraris, *Prompta Bibliotheca* (ed. 1844) VII, 470, *Litt. testim.* "fidem faciunt de susceptis ordinibus et carentia impedimenti canonici quod clericos a celebratione divinorum removeat."

‡ Balsamon in Chalced. XI (Migne, *P.G.*, 137, 425); *v.* also Chalced. XIII (*ib.*, 437). But Zonaras (*ll.*) had held the *συστ. γρ.* to be one merely exonerating its bearer from an accusation. Renaudot, *ll.* and *Lit. Or. Coll.* I, 460 ff., terms a document similar in intention to ours *Systatica*.

§ Since writing this I learnt from the Rev. Archimandrite A. Paraschis that the Greek church uses the term *ἐνταλτήριον γράμμα*. It must be noted that this scarcely agrees with the *Euchologion*, ed. Goar, 300. The *συστατικὸν* in that work, 395, comes perhaps nearest among printed formulæ to our document.

|| *Cf.* Denzinger, *Rit. Or.*, II, 8, 9. Hatch, in *Dict. Chr. Ant.*, 1507, remarks that such a formula is found now only in the Eastern churches. It bears some resemblance to the *πρόκλησις* in the Greek Pontifical (ed. Habert, 570).

بسم الله الرؤف الرحيم
بسم الاب
والابن والروح
القدس الاله الواحد
(Blank.)

كرز
الولد المبارك

الحبيب

غبريل ابن ميخائيل

بارادة الله واتفاق الكنيحة

شمانسا كاملا

على بيعة الشهيد

تادرس الامير غريبي منشية

النصارى

من يد حقارتى انا

فيلاتائوس اسقف

στη οω εκερεωωη ελεμεωη

Εη ονομεωωτι τοτ πρε

κε τω τς κε τω Δ

γιοτ πηατι τοτ οτ μελη

5. ο ελλαχ φηλοθε πολ παπος κ, λεγοτ

Απερχηνωωηη

μεπυνηρι ετςμεΔ

ρωοττ* παγαπτος

γαδρινλ πυνηρι μεμεικανλ ζεφοτ

10. ωυ μεφ† μεμπμεΔ† πεκ

ληρικος ποττακον πτελι

ος εχεν†κκλνσιΔ πτε πατι

ος θεοζωρος πεστρατελατνη†

σαπμεεντ μεμλχηπεωω† π

15. πεχρεστιΔπο† ζεπτχιχ

Ητμεεταλλαχ Δποκ φηλοθε

المدينة الممدوحة اخميم

فى اليوم السابع عشر من شهر بشنس

من سنة الف تسعة وسبعة للشهدا الاطهار

πνεπισκοποτ πτε †πολ παπος

θεποτ †ζ μεμλβωτ παυονς

Χρ μερ Δ,οθ

* This, or the corresponding Arabic, seems to be the appropriate epithet of a deacon. In the *Admonition* read to him at the conclusion of the ordination, he is addressed as **الولد المبارك** while a presbyter is called "Brother" and a sub-deacon or reader "My Son" **ابنى**.

† Theodore *Στρατηλάτης*, son of John of Shutb, is celebrated on the 20th Epiphi. Nilles, *Kalendarium*² II, 697, identifies him with Theodore the Eastern (12th Tybi); but the Coptic church distinguishes them; cf., besides the Synaxarium, Zoega, p. 56; Gizeh *MS. Copt. 8021*, Paris *MSS. arab.* 148 and 263. F. Görres, *Licinian. Christenverfolg.*, 185 ff., argues that Theodore the General is a fabulous martyr. No church of his near Ahmim is mentioned by Abû Sâlih or Makrizi.

‡ That this is really a place-name is probable from the existence of the two **منشاة النصارى** in the *Récencement* of 1884 and one in Makrizi *ed.* Wüstenfeld, p. 7, though neither are in the neighbourhood of Ahmim. The reading **منشية** for this ill-written word was suggested by Mr. A. G. Ellis, and that this varies with **منشاة** is clear from the **منشاة اخميم** of 'Abd al-Latif (p. 701) which Ibn Dukmāk (٦٨) and apparently Yakût calls **منشية اخميم**. But there is no evidence for identifying the latter locality with that in our text. A similar Coptic name would be **μεμλπεωωτ**, Zoega, p. 18, in the eastern Delta, did the photogr. Hyvernat XL, 2 permit that reading. **μεμλπεωωτ**, used in a more general sense in Zoega 74, is unfortunately not rendered in the Arabic version (*Ann. Mus. Guimet*, XVII, 384).

§ Read **سبعين**.

وصار له السلطان
 عن قبل وضع اليد عليه
 ان يصنع ما يصنعوه
 الشمامسة امثاله
 الا السما يباركه
 في جميع اعماله ويملا
 من كل فيها وحكمة
 ويؤيد به كل علما
 ونعمة
 ويجعله شريك
 الميراث مع القديس
 اسطافانوس رئيس هذه
 الطغمة في الخدمة
 الروحانية التي لاله الكلمة واهب
 العطايا العقلية

20. Οτοϩ ρεϣωπι παϣ πχε πιεϣωπι
 εβολ ριτεπτεετχαχιχ
 εϩρι εχωϣ ερι επι ετοϣρι
 εεωωω πχε παδακον επεϣρη
 Πφτ πτε τφε εφεεεωω ερωϣ
 25. εεπεϣεβνωι τηρω οτοϩ
 πτεεεεεεϣ κκατ πιβεν
 πεεεσοφια
 Οτοϩ πτεϣταχρο παϣ εεπε
 [ε] πιβεν πεεεχαριεεε
 30. Οτοϩ πτεϣεϣω πιϣφνηρ κκ
 ληροποεεω πεεεπεεωωεεε στε
 φακω παρχηνωσ πταγταεεε
 εεπτατοϣρηε εεπαττικε
 εεφεϣεεεεω πιηζορεεε πιω
 35. ηρεε

وسلام الرب
 يحل عليه وبركته ونعمته
 يكونا معه الى الابد
 امين
 وطقسه في الكنيسة
 يتبع من تقدمه
 من الشمامسة
 وهو مسعوك ابن سليمان
 منذ وضع اليد عليه
 والمجد والاکرام
 الثالث المقدس المساوي
 الى الابد امين

- † ϩϩρηνη πτε φτ εσεϣωπι ϩι
 χωϣ πεϣεεωω πεεεπεϣ
 ϩεωωτ ετχη πεεεεϣ εεεεε
 εεεηη
 40. Τεϣταεις εε εεπτεκλνηε
 εεεεωωω πιεαφνη εταεϣεω
 ϣη ερωϣ εβολ εεπηεεεεεε
 [ε]τεεεεεεεε* πιϣρη πσοεεεωω
 ιεεεπηεεεεε εχωϣ
 45. εοτωωω εε πεεεωωωωωωωω πτ
 εριεε εε ποεεωωωωωωωωωω
 εεεηηη

* The letter ε is rarely if ever thus heeded in Coptic transcriptions.

“With God (σὺν θεῷ), the pitiful (ὀικτίρμων), the merciful (ἐλεήμων).
In the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Ghost, One
God (ἐν ὀνόματι τοῦ πατρὸς καὶ τοῦ υἱοῦ καὶ τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος
θεοῦ μίαν σὺν).

[I.] the humble (ἐλάχιστος) Philotheos of the town (πόλις) Panos
[write] and say (λέγω);

The blessed [and] beloved (ἀγαπητός) son, Gabriel the son of
Misael, has, by God's will and the consent of the clergy
(κληρικός), been ordained (χειροτονεῖν) a full (τέλειος) deacon
(διάκων) for the church (ἐκκλησία) of Saint (ἄγιος) Theodore the
General (στρατηλάτης), on the west of the Meeting-place of the
Christians, at the hand of my humility (ἐλάχιστος), Philotheos,
the bishop (ἐπίσκοπος) of the* town (πόλις) Panos, on the 17th
day of the month Pachon, in the Era of the Martyrs (χρόνῳ
μαρτύρων) 1079 (= A.D. 1363).

And he has power, through this laying-on of hands, to perform the
acts which the deacons like him perform.

May the God of heaven bless him in all his works and fill him
with all prudence and wisdom (σοφία) and establish him in all
knowledge and [every] gift (χάρισμα), and make him co-heir
(κληρονόμος) with the blessed Stephen, the leader (ἀρχηγός) of
this order (τάγμα) in the spiritual (πνευματικός) service (λειτουργία)
of the Giver of intellectual (νοερός) gifts (δωρεά). May the peace
(εἰρήνη) of God be upon him, His blessing and His grace be
with him for ever. Amen.

Now (δὲ) his rank (τάξις) in the church [is that] from his consecra-
tion he follow him of the deacons that precedes him, namely
Mes'oud, the son of Solomon; to the glory and honour of the
holy, consubstantial (ὁμοούσιος) Trinity (τριάς) for ever. Amen.”

* The Arabic adds “celebrated” or “highly-honoured.”



L'EXODE DES HÉBREUX.

PAR J. LIEBLEIN.

Selon l'opinion la plus répandue l'exode des Hébreux a eu lieu
sous le règne de Ménéphthès I, fils et successeur de Ramsès II.
Pour ma part j'ai depuis longtemps cherché démontrer que cet
événement tombait sous le règne d'Aménophis III qui d'après mon
système chronologique régna 1355-1318 a. J.-C.* J'étais forcé de
rejeter l'opinion générale sur ce point déjà par le motif que l'exode,
par rapport à l'histoire des Israélites, était chronologiquement fixé,
ayant lieu environ l'an 1320 a. J.-C., et que, par rapport à la chrono-
logie égyptienne, le pharaon Aménophis III régnait pendant ce
même temps. C'était une conséquence inévitable de tout mon
système chronologique.

Mais plus je réfléchis sur la question de l'exode hébreu, plus je
suis persuadé d'avoir tombé juste. Cependant je ne peux ni veux
pas ici approfondir la question dans tous ses détails. Renvoyant à
ce que j'en ai dit dans les ouvrages cités plus haut, je me bornerai
pour le moment à mettre en avant quelques nouveaux arguments
qui me semblent fortement parler en ma faveur. Ce qui a égaré les
savants, c'est que le texte biblique qui nous raconte ces événements,
surtout celui qu'on appelle le texte de l'Élohiste, sans aucun doute a
été rédigé aux temps de Ramsès II qui d'après moi régnait de 1180
à 1114 a. J.-C., c'est-à-dire environ deux cents ans après l'exode.
Dans cette époque, depuis la fin de la guerre de Ramsès II contre
les Khetti jusqu'à la mort de Ménéphthès, la relation entre l'Égypte
et la Syrie était très intime. L'influence politique, sociale et civilisa-
trice de l'Égypte dominait en Syrie, des Égyptiens y voyageaient et y
demeuraient comme fonctionnaires, gouverneurs ou administrateurs,
des idées, des mots et expressions comme des marchandises sont
échangées entre les deux pays, et des lettres sont envoyées de l'un
à l'autre.

* Lieblein, *Aegyptische Chronologie*, 1863, p. 116-125, et *Recherches sur la
chronologie égyptienne*, 1873, p. 136 sv.